HomeoClinic User Guide

Covers releases R0 + R1 (milestones M0 + M1): "Set up and protect".

This guide is cumulative. Each milestone's guide includes everything from the previous milestones plus the new features. This edition (R1) covers the walking-skeleton shell (R0) and the first-run setup, app lock, and backup/restore features (R1). Later editions (R2, R3, ...) will add patient records, cases, prescriptions, billing and more, on top of this.

HomeoClinic is a fully offline desktop application. It makes no network calls of its own: your patient data never leaves your computer, and everything in this guide works with the internet disconnected.

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1. Installing and opening the app (R0)

Ubuntu / Linux

You received one of these files:

- **`HomeoClinic_<version>_amd64.AppImage`** — portable, no installation. 1. Make it executable: right-click → Properties → Permissions → "Allow executing file as program", or in a terminal run `chmod +x HomeoClinic_*.AppImage`. 2. Double-click it (or run `./HomeoClinic_<version>_amd64.AppImage`).
- **`HomeoClinic_<version>_amd64.deb`** — installs into the system menu. 1. Install it: `sudo apt install ./HomeoClinic_<version>_amd64.deb`. 2. Launch "HomeoClinic" from your applications menu.

Windows

1. Run the **`.exe`** (NSIS) or **`.msi`** installer and follow the prompts. The app installs per-user; no administrator rights are required.
2. Launch "HomeoClinic" from the Start menu.

What you should see

- The application window opens within a few seconds.
- On a **brand-new installation**, the app opens the **first-run setup wizard** (see section 2).
- On an **already set-up installation**, the app opens the **lock screen** and asks for your PIN (see section 3).

The main application shell has:

- a **top bar** with a patient search box (press **F2** to focus it) and buttons for Help (**F1**) and Lock (**Ctrl+L**);
- a **left navigation** with Today, Backup and Settings (some items are disabled until later releases add their screens);
- a **status bar** at the bottom showing the save state, the last backup time, and the licence/trial state.

> In R1 the only working screens are the setup wizard, the lock screen, the empty **Today** screen and the **Backup** screen. Patient, case, billing and repertory features arrive in later releases.

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2. First-run setup wizard (R1)

The first time you open the app on a new computer, the setup wizard runs automatically. It has at most four short steps and should take only a couple of minutes. The language selector at the top is English for this release.

Step 1 — Doctor profile

Enter your professional details. These print on every prescription and receipt in later releases.

- **Full name** (required)
- **Qualification** (required) — e.g. BHMS, MD(Hom)
- **Registration number** and **Council** (required)
- **Phone** and **Email** (optional)
- **Signature image** and **Clinic logo** (optional)

Click **Next**. Required fields that are empty show an inline message under the field.

Step 2 — Clinic profile

- **Clinic name** (required)
- **Address** (required)
- **Default consultation fee** and **Default follow-up fee** (required) — amounts are shown in Indian number format
- **Phone**, **GSTIN**, **Timings** (optional)

Click **Next**.

Step 3 — Security (PIN and recovery code)

1. **Set a PIN** (4 to 6 digits) and **confirm** it. This PIN protects all your patient data.
2. Choose the **auto-lock** time (how many idle minutes before the app locks itself; default 15).
3. After the PIN is confirmed, the app shows a **one-time recovery code**. - **Write it down or click Print.** It is shown only once. - If you ever forget your PIN, this recovery code is the only way back into your data.
4. Tick **"I have saved my recovery code"** to continue.

> **Keep the recovery code safe and separate from the computer.** There is no way to recover your data without either the PIN or the recovery code — this is what keeps patient data private.

Step 4 — Licence

- Select **Start 30-day free trial**. This release uses a built-in **Development trial**; buying and importing a real licence arrives in a later release.

Click **Finish setup**. The app creates your encrypted database and opens the **Today** screen, unlocked and ready.

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3. Locking and unlocking the app (R1)

Your data sits behind a single PIN entry.

When the app locks

- **On every launch** after setup is complete.
- **Automatically** after the idle time you chose (default 15 minutes).
- **On demand** — press **Ctrl+L** or click the **Lock** button in the top bar at any time.

Unlocking

1. Type your **PIN** and press **Enter** (or click **Unlock**).
2. A correct PIN unlocks immediately and returns you to where you were.
3. A wrong PIN shows an inline message and lets you try again — the app is never locked you out or wiped for a wrong entry.

Forgot your PIN

1. On the lock screen, click **Forgot PIN?**.
2. Enter the **recovery code** from setup, then set and confirm a **new PIN**.
3. Click **Reset PIN**. You can now unlock with the new PIN.

> Unlocking and recovery happen entirely on your computer — no internet is used or required.

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4. Backing up your data (R1)

Open **Backup** from the left navigation (or click the "Last backup" chip in the status bar).

Back up now (to a folder or USB drive)

1. Under **Back up now**, choose a destination with **Choose folder...** or **Use USB drive...**.
2. Enter a **backup password** (at least 8 characters). The first time, you also confirm it.
3. Optionally tick **Remember on this PC** so scheduled backups never ask for the password again on this computer.
4. Click **Back up now**.

The app writes a single encrypted file, `*.hcbak`, containing your database and attachments. After writing, it verifies the file (checksum + decrypt test).

> The backup password is **separate** from your app PIN. You need this password to restore the backup on another computer, so store it safely.

Automatic daily backups

- Automatic daily backup keeps the last **14 daily**, **8 weekly** and **12 monthly** copies, pruning older ones.
- It runs on app close or the first launch of the day and uses your remembered password, so it never interrupts you.

Backup health

- The screen and the status-bar chip show when the **last good backup** ran.
- If the last successful backup is **more than 7 days old**, a warning banner appears prompting you to back up.

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5. Restoring from a backup (R1)

Use this to recover data, or to move to a new computer (install HomeoClinic on the new PC, then restore).

1. On the **Backup** screen, under **Restore from a backup**, click **Choose backup file (.hcbak)...**.
2. **Step 1 — File and password:** select the `.hcbak` file and enter its backup password. A wrong password is refused here and the wizard does not continue.
3. **Step 2 — Preview:** the app shows what the backup contains (counts and dates) **without changing anything yet**.
4. **Step 3 — Confirm:** click **Restore**. Before replacing anything, the app takes a **safety copy of your current data**, then swaps in the restored data. A mistaken restore is therefore recoverable.

After restore, your doctor and clinic profile (and, in later releases, all patient data and attachments) are back.

> Backup and restore perform **no network calls** and work fully offline.

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6. Quick reference — keyboard shortcuts (R0/R1)

Key	Action
F1	Help
F2 / Ctrl+K	Focus patient search
F3	Today
Ctrl+L	Lock the app now
Enter	Confirm the current step / unlock
Esc	Close a dialog (never discards data)

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7. Privacy and safety notes (R1)

- **Offline only.** HomeoClinic makes no network connections of its own and opens no listening ports.
- **Encrypted at rest.** Your database and attachments are encrypted; the key is derived from your PIN.
- **No data in logs.** Diagnostic logs never contain patient details.
- **Your data is always recoverable** with your PIN or your recovery code, and always **exportable** via backup.

Appendix — what is NOT in this release

The following arrive in later milestones and are intentionally absent or disabled in R1: patient registration and search, case taking and follow-ups, prescriptions and printing, billing and reports, the repertory and materia medica, buying/importing a real licence, the global font-size setting, the data-folder chooser, and the guided "move to a new computer" flow. When those ship, this guide will be extended to cover them.

HomeoClinic User Guide — R1 edition (M0 + M1). Generated from `documents/user-guide/HomeoClinic-User-Guide-R1.md`.